



Steadying the household when a case changes everything.

This is a general budgeting tool, not financial or legal advice. If debts are serious, a nonprofit credit counselor can help at low or no cost.

Source of income	Amount per month	Still coming? (Y/N)

[illegible]

What can be cut or paused

Everything that is not keeping you housed, fed, safe, and compliant with the court is a candidate. Be honest, be temporary.

Non-essential expense	Amount per month	Cut / pause / keep

The monthly picture

Total coming in: _____

Total essentials: _____

What is left (or short): _____

If you are coming up short

- Contact creditors before you miss a payment and ask about hardship options. Many exist and are not advertised.
- Prioritize housing, utilities, food, and court obligations over unsecured debt.
- A nonprofit credit counseling agency can help you build a plan at low or no cost. Avoid anyone charging large upfront fees to fix debt.
- Keep the court's financial obligations current if you possibly can; falling behind there has its own consequences.

This workbook is educational and reflects lived and professional experience. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Laws and procedures vary by jurisdiction and change over time. For advice about your situation, consult a licensed attorney in your state.

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